

OpenClaw Model Switching

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1. Course Content

This course will systematically introduce the working mechanism of model selection in OpenClaw and three methods for switching models.

2. Temporarily Switch Session Model

2.1 Open TUI Session

- Enter in terminal:

```
openclaw tui
```

2.2 Use /model to Switch Session Model

Command	Description
<code>/model</code>	View available model list, select to switch model

- Enter `/model` in the session box and press Enter. For example, here we choose to switch to `bailian/qwen3.5-plus`. Use the keyboard up and down keys to select the model, then press Enter.

```
agent main | session main (openclaw-tui)search: >   
→ bailian/glm-4.7  
bailian/MiniMax-M2.5  
bailian/qwen3.5-plus
```

What kind of model are you?

I'm running on **Qwen3.5-Plus** (from Alibaba Cloud's Bailian platform).

This is my current model configuration:

- **Model:** bailian/qwen3.5-plus
- **Reasoning:** Currently off (can be toggled with /reasoning)
- **Runtime:** Agent=main, Host=raspberrypi (arm64)

I'm a personal assistant running inside OpenClaw, with the ability to control physical hardware through my robot body (servos, sensors, cameras, etc.) and interact with various services like Feishu/Lark, web browsers, and more.

Is there anything specific you'd like to know about my capabilities? 

connected | idle

agent main | session main (openclaw-tui) | bailian/qwen3.5-plus | tokens
41k/1.0m (4%)

3. Switch Default Model

3.1 Switch via CLI

The simplest way is to use CLI commands to directly set the default model:

- Here we take switching to the `bailian/qwen3.6-plus` model as an example.

```
openclaw models set bailian/qwen3.6-plus
```

```
Updated ~/.openclaw/openclaw.json
Default model: bailian/qwen3.6-plus
jetson@vabhoom:~$
```

3.2 Switch via Configuration File

- Edit the `openclaw.json` configuration file to modify the Agent's default model.

```
nano $HOME/.openclaw/openclaw.json
# Or use your preferred editor, such as vim, code, etc.
```

In `openclaw.json`, specify the default primary model via the `agents.defaults.model.primary` configuration item:

```
{
  "agents": {
    "defaults": {
      "model": {
        "primary": "bailian/qwen3.5-plus"
      }
    }
  }
}
```

```
"agents": {
  "defaults": {
    "model": {
      "primary": "bailian/qwen3.5-plus"
    },
  },
}
```

- Verify if the configuration is effective:

```
openclaw models status
```

```
before runtime loads
Config      : ~/.openclaw/openclaw.json
Agent dir   : ~/.openclaw/agents/main/agent
Default     : bailian/qwen3.5-plus
Fallbacks (0) : -
Image model  : -
Image fallbacks (0): -
Aliases (0)  : -
Configured models (9): bailian/qwen3.5-plus, bailian/qwen3.6-plus, bailian/qwen3-max-2026-01-23, bailian/qwen3-coder-next, bailian/qwen3-coder-plus, bailian/MiniMax-M2.5, bailian/glm-5, bailian/glm-4.7, bailian/kimi-k2.5
```

Note: When modifying the configuration file, be careful not to add commas or other symbols at the end of the configuration.

4. Add Model Option List

- `agents.defaults.models` is the **allowlist/directory** in OpenClaw that controls the scope of usable models. When this configuration item is set, users can only use models included in the list, which serves as the basis for model scope control for both the `/model` command and session overrides.

4.1 Add Models via Configuration File

Configure `agents.defaults.models` in `openclaw.json` to add the models you need to use to the allowlist:

```
"agents": {
  "defaults": {
    "model": {
      "primary": "bailian/qwen3.5-plus"
    },
    "models": {
      "bailian/qwen3.5-plus": {},
      "bailian/MiniMax-M2.5": {},
      "bailian/glm-4.7": {}
    },
    "workspace": "/home/sunrise/.openclaw/workspace",
    "compaction": {
      "mode": "safeguard",
      "memoryFlush": {
        "enabled": false
      }
    }
  }
}
```

```

2  "agents": {
3    "defaults": {
4      "model": {
5        "primary": "bailian/qwen3.5-plus"
6      },
7      "models": {
8        "bailian/qwen3.5-plus": {},
9        "bailian/MiniMax-M2.5": {},
10       "bailian/glm-4.7": {}
11      },
12      "workspace": "/home/pi/.openclaw/workspace",
13      "compaction": {
14        "mode": "safeguard",
15        "memoryFlush": {
16          "enabled": false
17        }
18      }
19    }
20  },

```

4.2 Model Reference Format Specification

In OpenClaw, all model references use a unified format:

Provider/ModelID

Examples:

Model Reference	Description
anthropic/claude-opus-4-6	Anthropic's Claude Opus model
anthropic/claude-sonnet-4-6	Anthropic's Claude Sonnet model
openai/gpt-5.4	OpenAI's GPT-5.4 model
openrouter/moonshotai/kimi-k2	Case where the model ID itself contains a slash

Note: If the model ID itself contains `/` (e.g., `moonshotai/kimi-k2`), you must provide the reference in the full `openrouter/moonshotai/kimi-k2` format.

5. Appendix: CLI Command Quick Reference

Command	Purpose
<code>openclaw onboard</code>	Beginner guide to help quickly complete initial configuration
<code>openclaw models list</code>	View the list of all configured models
<code>openclaw models status</code>	View detailed current model configuration status
<code>/model</code>	View available model list in chat
<code>/model status</code>	View detailed current model status in chat

